

October 2009—the first time an exchange rate was established for the nascent digital currency—one would now have over \$100 million. In November 2013, if one had invested that same \$100 in bitcoin, one would have endured an 86 percent drop by January 2015. There are nearly 800 other stories to tell, considering there are over 800 cryptoassets floating on globally connected and ever-on markets. At the end of 2016, a list of the top 50 included:¹²

Bitcoin, Ethereum, Ripple, Litecoin, Monero, Ethereum Classic, Dash, MaidSafeCoin, NEM, Augur, Steem, Iconomi, Dogecoin, Factom, Waves, Stellar Lumens, DigixDAO, Zcash, Lisk, Xenixcoin, E-Dinar Coin, Swiscoin, GameCredits, Ardor, BitShares, LoMoCoin, Bytecoin, Emercoin, AntShares, Gulden, Golem, Tether, ShadowCash, Xaurum, Storjcoin, Stratis, Nxt, Peercoin, I/O Coin, Rubycoin, Bitcrystals, SingularDTV, Counterparty, Agoras Tokens, Siacoin, YbCoin, BitcoinDark, SysCoin, PotCoin, and Global Currency Reserve.

This book will be the first of its kind to dive deep into a number of these. While many have slipped under the mainstream radar, the opportunities they present may be just as great as bitcoin.

We hope to transform today's intelligent investor into an innovative investor by providing a guide that explains what cryptoassets are, why they should be considered, and how to invest in them. Written by Benjamin Graham, *The Intelligent Investor* is a seminal work on value investing that Warren Buffet crowned as “the best book about investing ever written.”¹³ While we can only hope to achieve a fraction of the success Graham had in educating investors, our goals are very similar. We have chosen to focus on an asset class that didn't